up a regular contribution on automation. That way, you've made your first big step, but your ongoing investing follows a dollar-cost averaging approach, gradually adding more overtime, without needing to think about timing the market.

How to place your first trade

You're going to hate how anticlimactic this is. Unfortunately, after you make your first trade there is no confetti and Warren Buffet doesn't come knock on the door to congratulate you.

Placing a trade is incredibly simple and … boring? Most platforms will guide you through it step by step, but the process looks something like this:

1. **Search for your chosen fund/stock.**

   Use the ticker code or fund name in the search bar. For example, VT or Vanguard Total World Fund

2. **Enter the amount you want to invest.**

   Some platforms let you buy a specific dollar amount (e.g. $100), others will ask you to enter the number of units you want to purchase. If you have $1000 and the stock price is $100, you would buy 10 units.

3. **Review and confirm the trade.**

   There are a few options of how you want to execute the trade. To start off, choosing 'market order' means you are purchasing it now, but the price might fluctuate by a few dollars between the time it took for you to hit confirm and the time it took to find a seller. Double-check the details, then hit confirm.

How to stay on track

Now that you've planted your first seed and set your Lazy 3 Portfolio in motion, let's talk about what comes next and how to stay on track for the long haul. Because investing isn't just about what you do on day one, it's about how you keep showing up for your future self over months, years and decades.